

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1134

By Briggs

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Sophia Chen, 2026
Valedictorian of Farragut High School.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those students who, through their natural talents and unflagging commitment to academic excellence, have distinguished themselves in the classroom; and

WHEREAS, Sophia Chen is one such exceptional student, who was recently named the Valedictorian of the 2026 graduating class at Farragut High School; and

WHEREAS, through diligent study, steady composure during examinations, and steadfast commitment of time and talent, Ms. Chen has achieved outstanding academic success and joined the ranks of the best and brightest students in Tennessee and our country; and

WHEREAS, in her remarkable high school career, Sophia Chen has earned an exemplary grade point average of 4.785 while participating in numerous extracurricular activities, including HOSA, Mu Alpha Theta, tennis, and Youth in Government; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Chen is the president of the Science Club, the vice president of Youth in Government, and a violinist in the Knoxville Symphony Youth Orchestra; and

WHEREAS, she has earned numerous accolades, including placing as a semifinalist twice in the USA Biology Olympiad, being on the Tennessee Science Bowl champion team twice, receiving Youth in Government Best Speaker awards, and being selected as a National Merit Finalist and a Regeneron Science Talent Search Scholar; and

WHEREAS, Sophia Chen also performed research at the Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory for two years; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Chen's favorite pastimes are baking, playing and writing crossword puzzles, and working on political campaigns; and

WHEREAS, her display of intellectual aptitude and ambition surely bodes well for her future success; and

WHEREAS, Sophia Chen's noteworthy achievement is a tremendous source of pride for her parents, Feng Chen and Ju Guan, her school, and her community; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Chen's dedication to excellence is clearly deserving of the respect, admiration, and commendation of this General Assembly; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby commend and honor Sophia Chen of Farragut High School on being named the 2026 Valedictorian, salute her impressive academic achievement, and extend to her our best wishes for a happy, successful future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.